

The Language of Medicine

13th edition

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Chapter 4

Prefixes

Chapter Goals

- Define basic prefixes used in the medical language.
- Analyze medical terms that combine prefixes and other word elements.
- Learn about the Rh condition as an example of an antigen-antibody reaction.

Combining Forms (Slide 1 of 3)

Combining Form	Meaning
carp/o	wrist bones
cis/o	cut
cost/o	rib
cutane/o	skin
dactyl/o	fingers, toes
duct/o	lead, carry
flex/o	bend
gloss/o	tongue

Combining Forms (Slide 2 of 3)

Combining Form	Meaning
glyc/o	sugar
immun/o	protection
morph/o	shape, form
mort/o	death
nat/i	birth
norm/o	rule, order
ox/o	oxygen
pub/o	pubis; anterior portion of the pelvis
seps/o	infection

Combining Forms (Slide 3 of 3)

Combining Form	Meaning
somn/o	sleep
son/o	sound
the/o	put, place
thel/o, theli/o	nipple
tens/o	force, strain, stretch
thyr/o	thyroid gland; shield
top/o	place, position, location
tox/o	poison
trache/o	windpipe, trachea
urethr/o	urethra

Suffixes (Slide 1 of 2)

Suffix	Meaning
-crine	secrete
-drome	run
-fusion	coming together; to pour
-gea	substance that produces
-lapse	slide, fall, sag
-lysis	breakdown, destruction, separation
-meter	measure
-mission	send
-or	one who
-oxia	oxygen

Suffixes (Slide 2 of 2)

Suffix	Meaning
-partum	birth, labor
-phoria	bear, carry; feeling
-physis	grow
-plasia	development, formation, growth
-plasm	structure or formation
-pnea	breathing
-ptom	happening
-ptosis	falling, drooping, prolapse
-rrhea	flow, discharge
-stasis	stopping, controlling
-trophy	development, nourishment

Chapter 4

Lesson 4.1

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 1 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
a-, an-	no, not, without
ab-	away from
ad-	toward
ana-	up, apart
ante-	before, forward

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 2 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
anti-	against
auto-	self, own
bi-	two
brady-	slow
cata-	down
con-	with, together

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 3 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
contra-	against, opposite
de-	down, lack of
dia-	through, complete
dys-	abnormal, bad, painful, difficult
ec-	out, outside
endo-	in, within

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 4 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
epi-	upon, on, above
eu-	good, normal
ex-	out, outside
hemi-	half
hyper-	excessive, above
hypo-	deficient, under

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 5 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
in-	not
in-	into, within
infra-	beneath, under
inter-	between
intra-	in, within, into
macro-	large

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 6 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
mal-	bad
meta-	beyond, change
micro-	small
neo-	new
pan-	all
para-	abnormal, beside, near

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 7 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
per-	through
peri-	surrounding
poly-	many, much
post-	after, behind
pre-	before, in front of
pro-	before, forward

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 8 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
pros-	before, forward
re-	back, again
retro-	behind, backward
sub-	under
supra-	above, upper
syn-, sym-	together, with

Prefixes and Terminology

(Slide 9 of 9)

Prefix	Meaning
tachy-	fast
trans-	across, through
ultra-	beyond, excess
uni-	one

QUICK QUIZ (Slide 1 of 3)

- 1. Which term means a muscle that draws a limb TOWARD the body? (Watch spelling!)**
 - A. Adducter
 - B. Abductor
 - C. Adductor
 - D. Abducter

QUICK QUIZ (Slide 2 of 3)

2. Which term means painful breathing?

- A. Dyspnea
- B. Dysplasia
- C. Apnea
- D. Cephalgia

A Closer Look:

Antigens and Antibodies; the Rh Condition

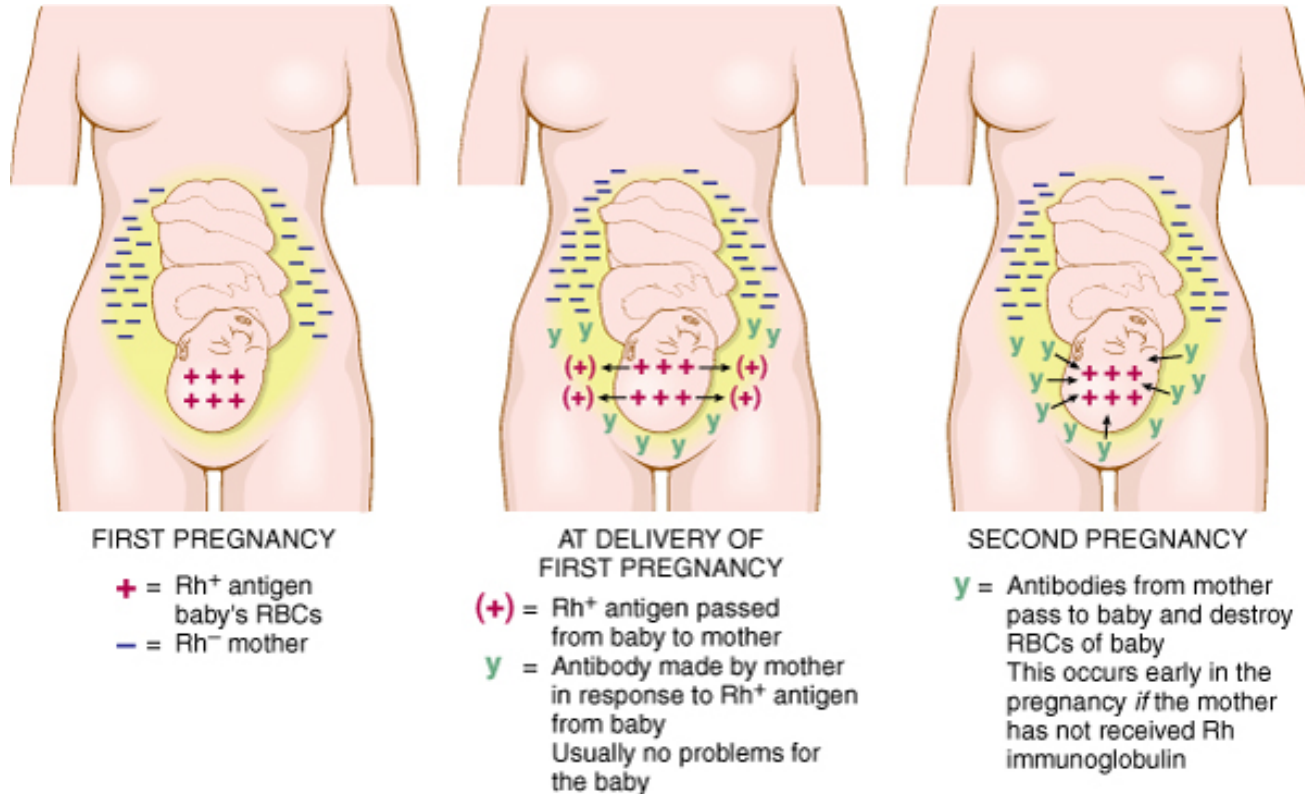
Background on Rh Condition

- **Antigen:** A substance, usually foreign to the body, that stimulates the production of antibodies.
- **Antibodies:** Protein substances made by white blood cells in response to the presence of foreign antigens.

Rh Condition (Slide 1 of 2)

- **Rh Condition:** An antigen-antibody condition that develops when there is a difference in Rh blood factor between that of the pregnant mother (Rh negative) and that of the fetus (Rh positive).

Rh Condition (Slide 2 of 2)



QUICK QUIZ (Slide 3 of 3)

3. Antibodies are made by what type of cell?

- A. Platelets
- B. Leukocytes
- C. Thrombocytes
- D. Erythrocytes

A Closer Look:

Congenital Anomaly

- **Congenital anomaly:** An irregularity in a structure or organ that an infant is born with.
- Examples are webbed fingers or toes (syndactyly), heart defects, and clubbed feet
- Some congenital anomalies are hereditary; others are produced by factors present during pregnancy; for example, **fetal alcohol syndrome** when a pregnant woman drinks high levels of alcohol, resulting in physical and mental defects in the infant at birth

A Closer Look:

Recombinant DNA

- **Recombinant DNA:** Taking a gene from one organism and inserting it into the DNA of another organism.
- Recombinant techniques are used to manufacture insulin outside the body
- **CRISPER** is an acronym for a technique to change DNA sequences and turn off genes or replace them with new versions.

A Closer Look:

Syndromes

- **Syndrome:** A group of signs or symptoms that commonly occur together and indicate a particular disease or abnormal condition
- **Reye syndrome** is characterized by vomiting, swelling of the brain, increased intracranial pressure, hypoglycemia, and dysfunction of the liver; may occur in children after a viral infection that has been treated with aspirin

A Closer Look:

Transurethral Resection of the Prostate Gland

- **Transurethral** resection of the prostate gland (TURP)
- A portion of the prostate gland is removed with an instrument passed through (**trans-**) the urethra
- The procedure is indicated when prostatic tissue increases (hyperplasia) and interferes with urination

A Closer Look: Ultrasonography

Ultrasonography:

Diagnostic technique using ultrasound waves to produce an image or photograph of an organ or tissue.

- **Echocardiogram:**
ultrasound image of the heart
- **Sonogram:**
fetal ultrasound image

